



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Italy. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — it gives a great starting point for good advice. Since you're 16, born and raised in Denmark, fluent in Danish, and just finished *folkeskolen* (primary/lower secondary education), you now have a few main options. The right path depends on your interests, learning style, and career goals, but here's a breakdown of your choices and who they suit best:

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are academically focused and prepare you for university.

a) STX (Studentereksamen) – General upper secondary

- Broad and academic, with a mix of humanities, science, and social science.
- Good if you enjoy general subjects and want to keep options open.
- Duration: 3 years.

b) HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- Focus on business, economics, and languages.
- Ideal if you're interested in business or international trade.
- Duration: 3 years.

c) HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- Focus on science, technology, and innovation.
- Great for those into IT, design, engineering, or natural sciences.
- Duration: 3 years.

d) HF (Higher Preparatory Examination Programme)

- More compact and slightly less academic than STX.
- Good if you want a shorter 2-year option that still allows university access.

 **Best for you if:** You like school and want to keep your options open for higher education later (university, professional bachelor, etc.).

2. Erhvervsuddannelse (Vocational Education and Training – VET/EUD)

Practical education where you learn a trade or profession (e.g., electrician, chef, carpenter, hairdresser, IT support).

- Combines school and apprenticeship.
- Often includes wages during training.
- You can also do *EUX*, which combines vocational training with upper secondary education and gives access to higher education.

 **Best for you if:** You prefer hands-on work, know what profession you're interested in, or want to start earning earlier.

3. International Options / Exchange

With your Italian roots, maybe you'd consider spending a year abroad or attending an international program:

- Some schools offer International Baccalaureate (IB) – in English, internationally recognized.
- Might be a good fit if you're strong in English, internationally minded, or considering studying abroad later.

 **Best for you if:** You want international opportunities or are fluent in English and open to studying in an international environment.

How to Choose?

Ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy academic subjects or prefer practical tasks?
 - Do I want to go to university later?
 - Do I want to start working sooner?
 - Am I interested in business, tech, creative fields, or trades?
 - Would I enjoy an international environment?
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Suggested Steps:

1. **Talk to a Studievejleder (Educational Counselor)** – They're available at *UU-centre* in your kommune.
 2. **Visit open house events (*Åbent Hus*)** at gymnasiums or vocational schools.
 3. **Try a "brobygning" or internship week** to test a specific program.
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If you tell me more about your interests (e.g., what subjects you like, your hobbies, whether you enjoy schoolwork, etc.), I can give you a more personalized recommendation.